

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 5 4 2
 ♥ 5 4
 ♦ K Q 4 3
 ♣ 9 6 5

♠ K 9 6 3

♥ A 7

♦ J 10 9

♣ A J 10 7



♠ 8

♥ J 10 6 3 2

♦ A 8 5

♣ 8 4 3 2

♠ Q J 10 7

♥ K Q 9 8

♦ 7 6 2

♣ K Q

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

When you have two 4-card suits to show you bid them "up-the-line". In this case it means you say 1 ♥. Partner replies 1 ♠.

There are enough points for game and a known 8-card Major fit. So you bid 4 ♠.

Perfect bidding isn't always rewarded. They can win three ♦ tricks and the Ace of trumps. If the opening lead is a ♥ or a ♣ you might make it, so it just depends on luck.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 10 4
 ♥ J 9 7
 ♦ A K 7 2
 ♣ K 5 3

♠ Q 6 2
 ♥ Q 4 2
 ♦ 4 3
 ♣ Q J 10 8 7



♠ A J 5
 ♥ K 10 6
 ♦ Q 9 8 6
 ♣ A 9 6

♠ 9 8 7 3
 ♥ A 8 5 3
 ♦ J 10 5
 ♣ 4 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1 ♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			

You have two very good choices, neither of which is really wrong. You could bid 2NT, showing 13-16 points, balanced, or you could bid 3♦, showing 13-16 points, good trump support.

What should decide you is the bidding priorities. You'd much rather try to play a 9-trick game than an 11-trick game. And at the same time you must trust your partner not to leave you hung out in Notrump with an unsuitable hand. (Can you believe I wrote Notrump and unsuitable in the same sentence?)

Anyway, you bid 2NT and partner raises to 3NT.